

ANIMALS IN DANGER

Great white shark

IUCN status: vulnerable

Population estimate: unknown

KEY

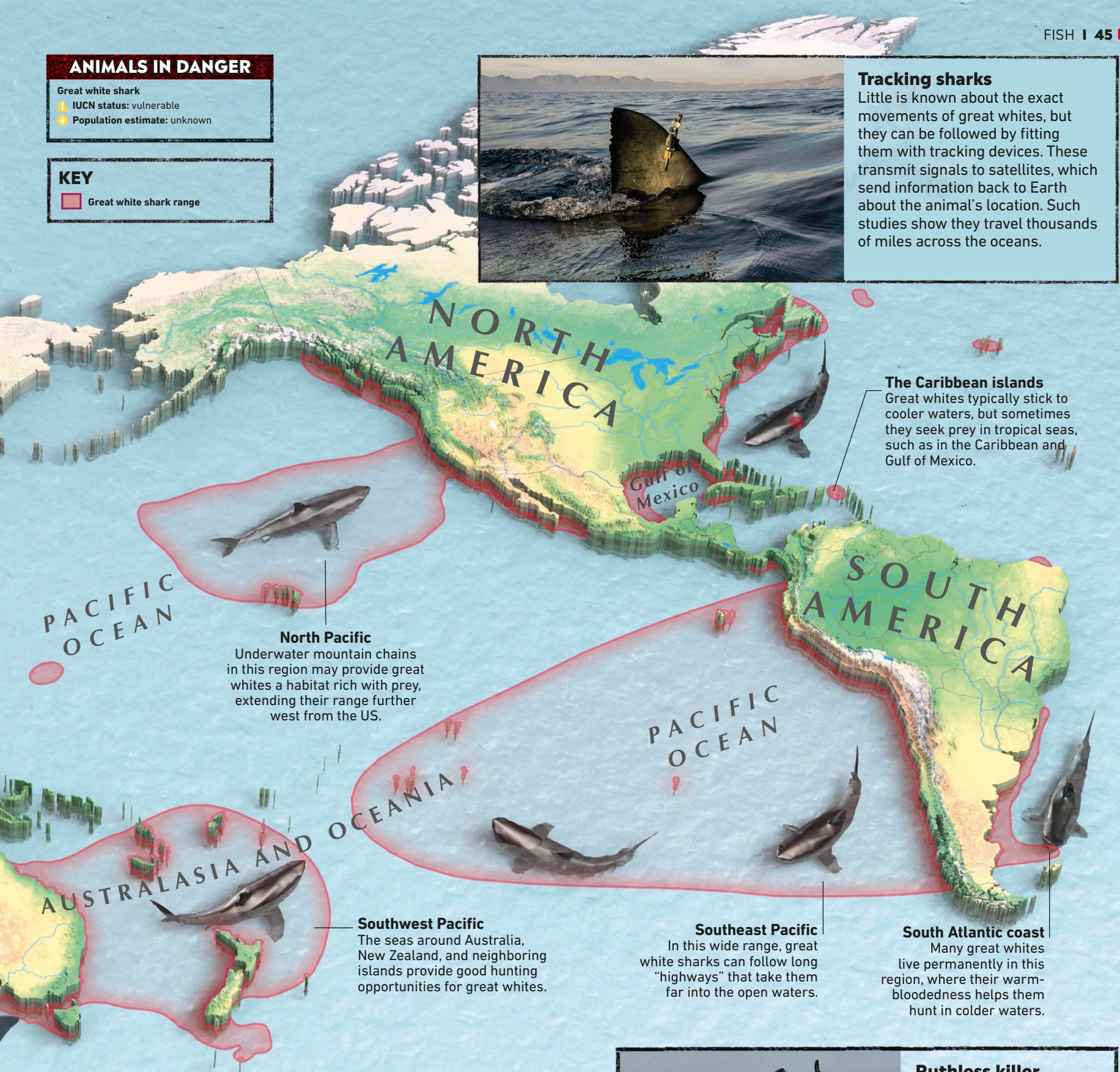
Great white shark range

Tracking sharks

Little is known about the exact movements of great whites, but they can be followed by fitting them with tracking devices. These transmit signals to satellites, which send information back to Earth about the animal's location. Such studies show they travel thousands of miles across the oceans.

The Caribbean islands

Great whites typically stick to cooler waters, but sometimes they seek prey in tropical seas, such as in the Caribbean and Gulf of Mexico.



PACIFIC OCEAN

North Pacific

Underwater mountain chains in this region may provide great whites a habitat rich with prey, extending their range further west from the US.

PACIFIC OCEAN

Southwest Pacific

The seas around Australia, New Zealand, and neighboring islands provide good hunting opportunities for great whites.

Southeast Pacific

In this wide range, great white sharks can follow long "highways" that take them far into the open waters.

South Atlantic coast

Many great whites live permanently in this region, where their warm-bloodedness helps them hunt in colder waters.

Long-distance wanderer

The great white shark is the world's widest-ranging fish and can be found in most oceans, but is found most often in the ranges shown on this map. Unusually for a fish, it maintains a high body temperature, helping it survive in colder waters and chase down warm-blooded mammals.



**A GREAT WHITE SHARK
CAN HAVE UP TO 300 TEETH**

**Ruthless killer**

Once a great white shark sights a target near the water's surface, it moves in quickly for the kill. It attacks its prey, such as this sea lion, with a single ferocious bite—and in the process can breach the surface in spectacular fashion. It then lets the victim bleed to death before starting to feed.